



STEADY BURN

Forging A Stronger Purposeful Man

FIRE - FURNACE - FORGE

WEEK 23 WORKSHEET GUIDE

TRACE YOUR ORIGIN STORY

INTRODUCTION

Every man has a story.

Most men know the events.

Few understand the impact.

The goal of this exercise is not to judge your past. It is not to blame your parents, your circumstances, or the people who influenced you. It is not an excuse-making exercise.

It is an awareness exercise.

Long before you made your first major adult decision, your view of the world was already being shaped. Family dynamics, successes, failures, mentors, losses, victories, disappointments, and environments all left marks on you. Some became strengths. Some became limitations. Most became invisible.

The problem is not that these influences exist.

The problem is that many men never examine them.

When a belief remains unexamined, it often becomes automatic. You stop seeing it as a belief and start seeing it as reality.

This week you will step back and become the storyteller of your own life.

Not the victim.

Not the hero.

Not the judge.

The observer.

Your job is to identify the moments that forged you, discover the lessons they taught, and decide which lessons deserve a place in your future.

As you work through this worksheet, remember one important rule:

Write honestly, not dramatically.

The most valuable answers are often the simplest and most truthful.

Let's begin.

T

TRACK THE CHAPTERS

Before you can understand your story, you need to map it.

Most men think about their lives as one long continuous experience. This exercise asks you to break it into chapters.

Think about the major periods of your life:

- Childhood
- Teen years
- Early adulthood
- Recent years

For each phase, identify events, people, environments, or experiences that significantly influenced who you became.

Do not worry about whether the event was good or bad.

Focus on impact.

Fill Out This Section By:

- Listing major life events
- Naming important people
- Recording major changes or transitions
- Identifying experiences you still remember clearly

Good Examples

- Parents divorced when I was 10
- Moved to a new city in middle school

- Grandfather taught me responsibility
- Lost a sports championship
- Joined the military
- Started my first business

Weak Examples

- School happened
- Life was normal
- Nothing really stands out
- Lots of things happened

The goal is specificity.

You are looking for moments that changed your direction, shaped your thinking, or left a lasting impression.

Ask yourself:

“What events would appear in the movie version of my life?”

Write those down.

R

REMEMBER THE LESSONS

Events matter.

Lessons matter more.

Two people can experience the same event and learn completely different things from it.

This section is about identifying the meaning you attached to those experiences.

Look at each event you listed.

Ask yourself:

- What did this teach me?
- What did I learn about people?

- What did I learn about myself?
- What did I begin to believe because of this?

Remember:

You are identifying the lesson you learned at the time.

Not necessarily the truth.

Fill Out This Section By:

Writing one lesson beside each event.

Strong Examples

Event: Parents divorced

Lesson: Relationships don't last forever.

Event: Coach believed in me

Lesson: Hard work gets noticed.

Event: Bullied in school

Lesson: People will attack weakness.

Weak Examples

Event: Parents divorced

Lesson: It was bad.

Event: Lost championship

Lesson: I was sad.

Those are feelings.

You are looking for beliefs.

A feeling is temporary.

A belief often stays for years.

Find the belief.

A

ANALYZE THE EFFECTS

Now connect the past to the present.

This is where many patterns become visible.

Look at each lesson you identified.

Ask:

- How does this still affect me?
- Where does this show up today?
- What behaviors came from this lesson?

Be brutally honest.

The goal is not to look good.

The goal is to become accurate.

Fill Out This Section By:

Writing current behaviors connected to past lessons.

Strong Examples

Lesson: People leave.

Current Effect: I struggle to trust relationships.

Lesson: Hard work gets noticed.

Current Effect: I push myself constantly.

Lesson: People attack weakness.

Current Effect: I rarely ask for help.

Weak Examples

Lesson: People leave.

Current Effect: Not sure.

Lesson: Hard work gets noticed.

Current Effect: Nothing.

If the lesson was powerful enough to remember, it probably still influences something.

Keep digging until you find the connection.

C

CLARIFY THE PATTERN

By now you have several lessons and several effects.

Look for themes.

Patterns often repeat across different events.

You may discover that multiple experiences taught the same lesson.

This is where your deeper story begins to emerge.

Review everything you have written.

Circle recurring beliefs.

Common Patterns

- Trust nobody
- Work harder than everyone
- Don't show weakness
- Stay in control
- Avoid conflict
- Keep people happy
- Never fail

- Handle everything yourself

Fill Out This Section By:

Identifying the beliefs that appear repeatedly.

Strong Examples

Pattern: I learned to handle everything alone.

Evidence: Parents absent, difficult breakup, business struggles.

Pattern: My value comes from achievement.

Evidence: School success, sports success, career success.

Weak Examples

Pattern: Life is complicated.

Pattern: Things happen.

Those are observations.

You are looking for recurring beliefs that drive behavior.

The pattern should explain multiple events at once.

When you find it, you'll often recognize it immediately.

E

EDIT THE ENDING

This is the most important section.

Awareness without action changes nothing.

Your origin story explains your current position.

It does not determine your future.

Review the patterns you identified.

Ask yourself:

- Which pattern helps me?
- Which pattern hurts me?
- Which belief no longer serves the man I want to become?

Choose one.

Only one.

Focus creates change.

Fill Out This Section By:

Writing:

1. The old belief
2. The cost of keeping it
3. The new belief you want to adopt

Strong Example

Old Belief: I must handle everything alone.

Cost: Isolation and unnecessary stress.

New Belief: Strong men ask for support when needed.

Another Example

Old Belief: My value comes from achievement.

Cost: Constant pressure and burnout.

New Belief: My value is not dependent on performance.

Weak Example

Old Belief: Life is hard.

New Belief: Life is good.

The replacement belief should directly challenge the old one.

Make it practical.

Make it specific.

Make it useful.

FINAL REVIEW

Before finishing the worksheet, read everything you wrote from beginning to end.

Notice the connections.

Notice the patterns.

Notice the beliefs.

Most importantly, notice that the story now makes more sense.

You did not choose every event that shaped you.

You did not choose every lesson you absorbed.

But today you have a choice.

You can continue carrying old beliefs without examining them.

Or you can consciously decide what remains part of your story.

The past forged you.

The future will be forged by the choices you make after understanding it.

That is the purpose of this exercise.

Not to rewrite your history.

To reclaim authorship of what comes next.